

HOW GOVERNMENTS TALK ABOUT

Budgets and property taxes.

It's tax-bill and budget-hearing season. Three ways governments are making the numbers make sense to the households reading them.

Three real posts from the past two weeks →

- Bloomfield Township, New Jersey
- La Crosse County, Wisconsin
- Commerce Township, Michigan

Explain the bill before the calls start.

Township of Bloomfield
about a week ago
Jenny Mundell
Mayor

Township of Bloomfield
Mayor's Office
1 Municipal Plaza
Bloomfield, NJ 07003

A MESSAGE FOR BLOOMFIELD TOWNSHIP TAX PAYERS

As you receive your 2026 property tax bill, I want to explain the municipal tax increase reflected on your bill and why your fourth-quarter bill may be significantly higher than your third-quarter bill.

Because the Township's final 2026 Municipal Budget was adopted after third-quarter tax bills were issued, the municipal portion of your Q3 bill was based on an estimate. Your Q4 bill reflects the certified municipal tax rate plus the difference between the estimated amount billed in Q3 and the final amount due for the year. This is why the municipal portion of your Q4 bill may be significantly higher than Q3.

The 2026 budget reflects rising costs facing municipalities across New Jersey, including increases in health insurance, pensions, public safety, and wastewater treatment. The Township worked to limit the impact on taxpayers while maintaining essential services and reduced spending through operational efficiencies and cost-saving measures for the second consecutive year, while preserving core services without layoffs.

Your bill funds three separate entities, the Township sets only the municipal portion. School taxes account for 44.25% of your total property tax bill. Municipal taxes, including the Library Tax and Open Space, account for 41.82%. County taxes, including County Open Space, account for 13.83%.

While taxes are due November 1, there is a 10-day grace period during which no penalties are incurred. Residents enrolled in the Senior Freeze program must still pay their Township tax bill, and will be reimbursed for the 2026 increase when filing in 2027.

If you have questions about your bill or need assistance, please contact the Tax Office at 973-680-4049. Staff can connect eligible residents with Human Services for benefits screening and information about programs that may assist with gas and electricity bills, water and sewer fees, food, security deposits, and Medicare S and D costs. Eligibility requirements apply.

As Mayor, I remain committed to responsible financial management, transparency, and ensuring residents understand how their tax dollars are used. We will continue working to control costs, improve efficiency, and protect the services our community relies on.

Thank you for your continued engagement and for being part of our community.

Sincerely,
Jenny Mundell
Mayor
Township of Bloomfield

973-680-4049 | bloomfieldnj@nj.gov

2026 Property Tax Bill: A Message from Mayor Jenny Mundell

As residents receive their 2026 property tax bills, Mayor Mundell shares information about the municipal tax increase, why the Q4 bill may be higher than Q3, how property tax dollars are allocated, and resources available to eligible residents.

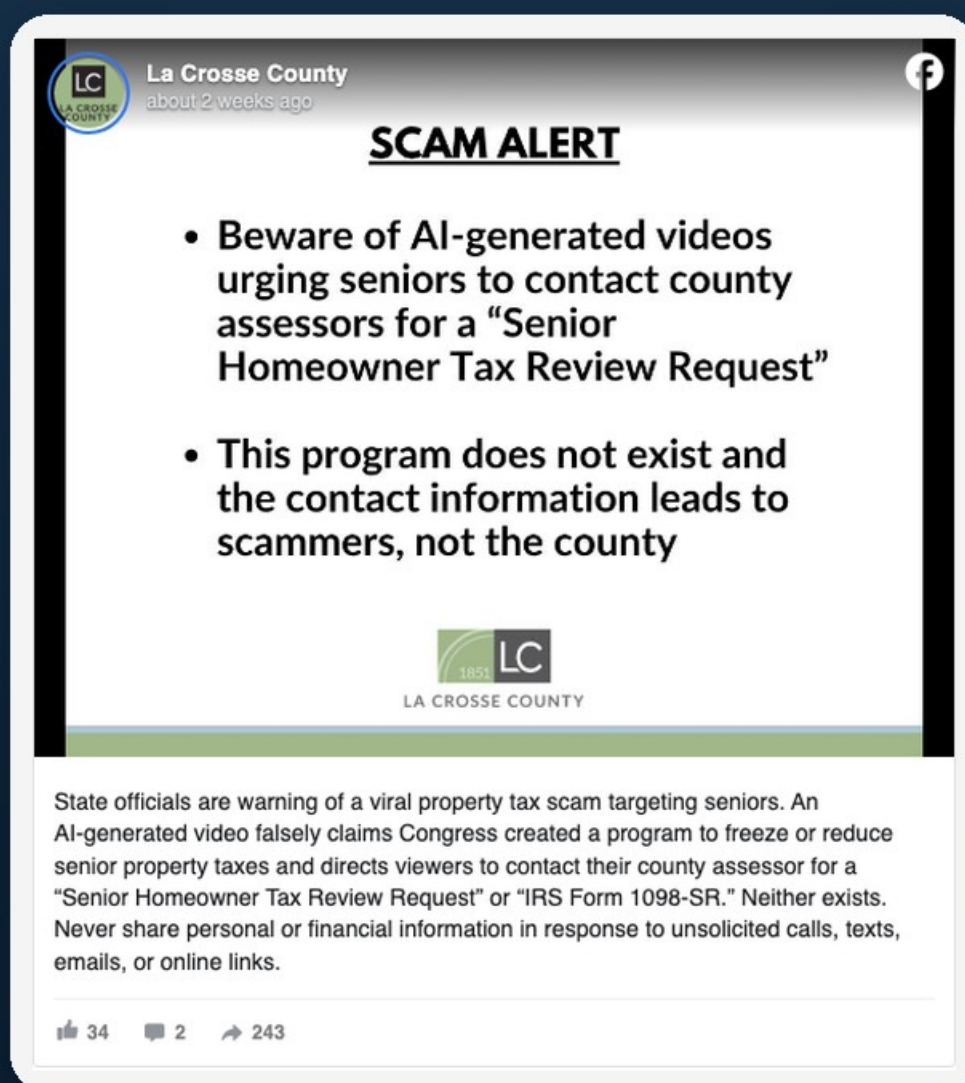
Read the full message below.

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WHY IT WORKS

As bills arrived, the mayor explained the increase, why the fourth-quarter bill may run higher than the third, where the dollars go, and what help exists.

Protect residents from the scam.



WHY IT WORKS

An AI-generated video told seniors to call their assessor about a tax program that doesn't exist. The county said it plainly: not real, and not us.

COMMERCE TOWNSHIP · MICHIGAN

Lay out what's on the ballot.

Charter Township of Commerce, Michigan
about 2 weeks ago

THE CHARTER TOWNSHIP OF COMMERCE
Twp. 100000
Commerce Township, Michigan 48384
(248) 945-1100
www.commercetwp.com

Commerce Township Pathway Bond & Millage Proposal to Appear on the November 3, 2026 General Election Ballot
FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE, September 10, 2025

Commerce Township, Mich. -- Commerce Township voters will use the following Pathway Bond & Millage proposal on the November 3, 2026 General Election ballot.

The ballot proposal asks voters whether Commerce Township should be authorized to borrow up to \$18.6 million through the issuance of Unlimited Tax General Obligation Bonds to acquire and construct paved non-motorized pathways throughout Commerce Township and the Village of Wolverine Lake.

If approved by voters, the bonds would fund the acquisition and construction of paved non-motorized pathways described in the Township's and Village's Parks and Recreation Master Plans, including design and other related improvements.

The ballot language is as follows:

For the purpose of acquiring and constructing one or more paved non-motorized pathways within the Charter Township of Commerce and the Village of Wolverine Lake as described in the Township's and Village's Parks and Recreation Master Plans, including their design and other related improvements, shall the Charter Township of Commerce, Oakland County, Michigan borrow a principal amount not to exceed \$18.6 million dollars and issue Unlimited Tax General Obligation bonds for all or a portion of that amount in one or more series payable over not to exceed 10 years from the date of issue?

The estimated new millage to be levied in the first year of the levy is 0.5986 mils (\$0.5986 per \$1,000 of taxable value) and the estimated single average annual millage rate required to retire the bonds over 10 years is 0.5989 mils (\$0.5989 per \$1,000 of taxable value).

Residents can review the ballot language and find additional election information, including voter registration, absentee voting, and polling locations, through the Commerce Township website:
<https://www.commercetwp.com/pathway-bond-millage/>

Media Contact:
Kaitlyn Potholm
Communications and Community Engagement Specialist, Commerce Township
kpotholm@commercetwp.com

About Commerce Township
Commerce Township, officially the Charter Township of Commerce, is a charter township of Oakland County in the U.S. state of Michigan. The population was 43,058 at the 2020 census.

Commerce: (248) 945-1100
Building: (248) 945-1100

Civil: (248) 945-1100
Planning: (248) 945-1100

Engineering: (248) 945-1100
Transportation: (248) 945-1100

Press Release: "Commerce Township and the Village of Wolverine Lake are providing information regarding the Pathway Bond & Millage Proposal that will appear on the November 3, 2026 General Election ballot.

The proposal asks whether the Charter Township of Commerce should be authorized to borrow up to \$18.6 million through Unlimited Tax General Obligation Bonds to acquire and construct paved non-motorized pathways within Commerce Township and the Village of Wolverine Lake."

T... See more

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WHY IT WORKS

A pathway bond and millage proposal heads to the November ballot. The township published the ballot language and what it would fund, and left the vote to voters.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Make the numbers make sense.

Residents don't need the budget document. They need to know what changed, why, and what it means for their household, from the people who can answer.

See how your community's posts compare with peers, free:

govfeeds.com/free-report

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